

IN PROFILE

Alma Schindler

Daughter of an Austrian landscape painter, Alma Schindler (1879–1964) was a promising composer when she married Mahler, 19 years her senior, in 1902. Marriage and motherhood suppressed her creativity. Following Mahler's death she married architect Walter Gropius, and later, after a divorce, writer Franz Werfel. Her other lovers included the composer Alexander von Zemlinsky and the artist Oskar Kokoschka. She bore four children, three of whom suffered early deaths. In 1938, when the Nazis took over Vienna, she fled with Werfel, first to France and then to the US, becoming a prominent figure among the European exiles in Los Angeles.



ALMA MAHLER AND HER DAUGHTERS MARIA AND ANNA, 1906

Loss and renewal

Mahler continued to compose in his spare time from conducting.